

Chapter 34-9

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Sally and Cherry arrived early.

Sally even brought a bottle of good wine, saying she wanted to drink to her heart's content with Liang Shi again.

Xu Qingzhu and Lin Luoxi both felt the two of them shouldn't drink alcohol.

As soon as Sally entered the door, she asked where Liang Shi was, and Xu Qingzhu casually replied: "She took her niece to buy kites."

"Flying kites in this weather? What kind of joke is that?" Lin Luoxi spoke with her Beijing accent¹. "It's not even spring."

"The weather is nice today," Xu Qingzhu said.

"Exactly." Sally agreed. "You don't understand children's happiness."

Lin Luoxi: "..."

She looked at her with disdain and contempt: "Right, you're the only one who understands, you understand even at eighty years old."

Sally: "?"

Her Chinese ability wasn't sufficient for her to digest this sarcastic remark, so she turned to ask Xu Qingzhu in English: "What does she mean?"

Lin Luoxi rolled her eyes and answered in English: "Childish, petty, so you'll be forever young, understand? Young person."

Her tone was extremely mocking.

"Hey now, you two stop bickering." Xu Qingzhu mediated in time. "If you start fighting in my house, I'll have to clean up the mess."

Lin Luoxi shrugged: "Who wants to argue with her? It's beneath me."

"OMG, Cherry." Sally launched into a long English tirade: "You seem like you can't speak nicely anymore. I can honestly say I haven't provoked you since I came back. You found a girlfriend after I left, while I've stayed single all this time, yet you still have to bully me like this? Is it because none of your subsequent girlfriends were as good as me? I can understand that, but I won't accept it. You're really being too passive-aggressive. My heart has to endure critical hits every day. If this continues, I'm going to get depressed."

Lin Luoxi glanced at her, remaining unusually calm: "Speak Chinese."

Sally: "Don't be angry anymore."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Although she was already used to the ever-changing atmosphere between these two, suddenly witnessing it still shocked her.

Clearly when Sally was speaking English, she was so assertive, but once she switched to Chinese, her attitude became completely meek.

Is this the advantage of linguistic home field?

Xu Qingzhu just asked them: "What would you like to drink? Coffee, beverages, or tea?"

"I want coffee." Lin Luoxi sat on the sofa. "I really can't pull all-nighters anymore. Bamboo, I've never taken on such high-intensity work before."

"Sorry about that." Xu Qingzhu said. "I'll hand-grind coffee for you."

"Then I want a beverage." Sally said. "Do you have orange juice?"

"In the fridge," Xu Qingzhu said while grinding coffee. "Get it yourself."

Sally opened the fridge and discovered small cakes. She inquired: "Are these cakes fresh? Can I eat them?"

"Yes, they were made this afternoon," Xu Qingzhu said.

"OMG, Blanche, you can actually make cakes now!" Sally was surprised and started speaking Chinese: "It's truly like not seeing someone for a day feels like three autumns²."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"Those were made by Liang Shi," Xu Qingzhu said. "My niece wanted to eat some this afternoon, so she made a few. I don't really like sweet things, so there are some left over."

"Liang Shi?!" Even Lin Luoxi was surprised and immediately said: "Give me a piece, let me taste Miss Liang San's³ handiwork."

Although Xu Qingzhu didn't like sweet foods, she gave a very sincere evaluation: "The taste is actually quite good."

Just as they were chatting, Liang Shi returned holding a kite in one hand and pulling Ling Dang with the other.

Ling Dang was holding a large bucket of popcorn, and the smell of fast food permeated the entire house.

Xu Qingzhu was shocked: "You took her to McDonald's?"

"She insisted on going," Liang Shi said pitifully.

Xu Qingzhu: "...Didn't she eat lunch already?"

Liang Shi fell silent.

After a moment, Liang Shi said helplessly: "She said she wanted to eat chicken legs and hamburgers."

Xu Qingzhu: "Then why is she holding popcorn?"

The Liang family would definitely not normally give Ling Dang this kind of junk food, but after being taken out by Liang Shi, the little girl finally got to run wild. With her masterful acting cute skills, she had coaxed Liang Shi into a daze, eventually reaching a state where she would buy whatever was requested.

By the time Liang Shi realized what was happening, the little girl had already consumed half a hamburger and a chicken leg, her belly bulging.

The other half of the hamburger remained because she really couldn't eat any more.

After all, she had also drunk a cup of cola.

The slender little girl had gone out for a trip, and her original princess dress was almost bursting at the seams.

Liang Shi also felt very guilty, but when a cute little girl acted spoiled with her soft and sweet voice, it was really irresistible.

Plus, Ling Dang had a sweet mouth and could coax people into a dizzy state.

Liang Shi was once again rendered speechless and awkwardly touched her nose.

Sally said from the side: "Blanche, why are you being so fierce? Liang Shi is just doting on her niece~ Who wouldn't love such a well-behaved and cute little child?"

Ling Dang blinked her eyes and smiled brilliantly: "Sister, you're so beautiful. Are your eyes sapphires?"

Sally immediately beamed with joy: "OMG, can I steal this little kid? I really want her."

Lin Luoxi snorted lightly: "Such a smooth talker at such a young age."

Hearing this, Ling Dang looked over, tilted her head, then covered her mouth in amazement: "I think I saw a fairy sister."

Lin Luoxi: "..."

Everyone: "?"

"Sister, you look like a fairy in your white dress," Ling Dang blinked. "I really like your dress, it's prettier than mine."

Lin Luoxi: "...I'll send you one tomorrow."

Ling Dang immediately bowed: "Thank you, sister! You're the most beautiful!"

Liang Shi looked helplessly at Xu Qingzhu and spread her hands—see, I'm not the only one who got coaxed into a dizzy state.

Sally had already scooped Ling Dang up in her arms: "My little princess, did you go steal some food?"

"Auntie took me to eat," Ling Dang reached out to pinch a piece of popcorn to feed her. "Is it tasty?"

"So sweet," Sally said.

Ling Dang giggled happily.

Footnotes:

¹ **Beijing accent (京片子):** A distinctive dialect/accnt from Beijing, often characterized by particular pronunciation patterns and intonation that differs from standard Mandarin.

² **"Not seeing someone for a day feels like three autumns" (一日不見如隔三秋):** A Chinese idiom expressing how time feels longer when you miss someone; used here somewhat humorously to express surprise at how quickly someone has changed.

³ **Miss Liang San (梁三小姐):** "San" means "third," referring to Liang Shi as the third daughter/young lady of the Liang family. This is a formal and somewhat old-fashioned way of addressing someone from a prominent family.